



Muhammad Shahid Ashraf

Random-Number Generation

NATIONAL UNIVERSITY
of Computer & Emerging Sciences

-



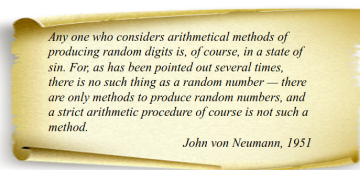
NATIONAL UNIVERSITY
of Computer & Emerging Sciences

- Shahid Ashraf CS4056 4 / 41

[illegible][illegible][illegible][illegible]

Pseudo-Random Numbers

- Approach: Arithmetically generation (calculation) of random numbers
- "Pseudo", because generating numbers using a known method removes the potential for true randomness.



- Goal: To produce a sequence of numbers in $[0,1]$ that simulates, or imitates, the ideal properties of random numbers (RN).

Notes

Pseudo-Random Numbers

- Important properties of good random number routines
 - Fast
 - Portable to different computers
 - Have sufficiently long cycle
 - Replicable
 - Verification and debugging
 - Use identical stream of random numbers for different systems
- Closely approximate the ideal statistical properties of
 - uniformity and
 - independence

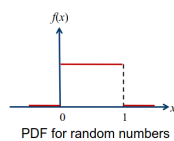
Notes

Pseudo-Random Numbers: Properties

- Two important statistical properties:
 - Uniformity
 - Independence
- Random number R_i must be independently drawn from a uniform distribution with PDF:

$$f(x) = \begin{cases} 1, & 0 \leq x \leq 1 \\ 0, & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

$$E(R) = \int_0^1 x dx = \frac{x^2}{2} \Big|_0^1 = \frac{1}{2}$$



Notes

Pseudo-Random Numbers

- Problems when generating pseudo-random numbers
 - The generated numbers might not be uniformly distributed
 - The generated numbers might be discrete-valued instead of continuous-valued
 - The mean of the generated numbers might be too high or too low
 - The variance of the generated numbers might be too high or too low
- There might be dependence:
 - Autocorrelation between numbers
 - Numbers successively higher or lower than adjacent numbers
 - Several numbers above the mean followed by several numbers below the mean

Notes

- Midsquare method
- Linear Congruential Method (LCM)
- Combined Linear Congruential Generators (CLCG)
- Random-Number Streams

Notes

- First arithmetic generator: Midsquare method
 - von Neumann and Metropolis in 1940s
- The Midsquare method:
 - Start with a four-digit positive integer Z_0
 - Compute: $Z_i^2 = Z_{i-1} \times Z_{i-1}$ to obtain an integer with up to eight digits
 - Take the middle four digits for the next four-digit number

i	Z_i	U_i	$Z_i \times Z_i$
0	7182	-	51581124
1	5811	0.5811	33767721
2	7677	0.7677	58936329
3	9363	0.9363	87665769
...			

Notes

- Problem: Generated numbers tend to 0

i	Z_i	U_i	$Z_i \times Z_i$
0	7182	-	51581124
1	5811	0.5811	33767721
2	7677	0.7677	58936329
3	9363	0.9363	87665769
4	6657	0.6657	44315649
5	3156	0.3156	09960336
6	9603	0.9603	92217609
7	2176	0.2176	04734976
8	7349	0.7349	54007801
9	78	0.0078	00006084
10	60	0.006	00003600
11	36	0.0036	00001296
12	12	0.0012	00000144
13	1	0.0001	00000001
14	0	0	00000000
15	0	0	00000000

Notes

- To produce a sequence of integers $X_1, X_2, \dots$ between 0 and $m-1$ by following a recursive relationship:

$$X_{i+1} = (aX_i + c) \bmod m, \quad i = 0, 1, 2, \dots$$

The multiplier

The increment

The modulus

- Assumption: $m > 0$ and $a < m, c < m, X_0 < m$
- The selection of the values for a, c, m , and X_0 drastically affects the statistical properties and the cycle length
- The random integers X_i are being generated in $[0, m-1]$

Notes



What is the Linear Congruential Method (LCM)

LCM Formula

$$X_{n+1} = (aX_n + c) \mod m$$

- Generates a sequence of integers between 0 and $m - 1$.
- These integers can be normalized to $[0,1)$ by dividing by m .

Shahid Ashraf CS4056 13 / 41

Notes



LCM Components

- X_0 : Seed value (starting value)
- a : Multiplier
- c : Increment
- m : Modulus
- Each choice affects the quality and period of the generated sequence.

Shahid Ashraf CS4056 14 / 41

Notes



Periodicity and Full-Period Conditions

- Maximum period is m .
- Full period if:
 - 1 c and m are relatively prime,
 - 2 $a - 1$ divisible by all prime factors of m ,
 - 3 If m divisible by 4, then $a - 1$ divisible by 4.

Shahid Ashraf CS4056 15 / 41

Notes



Advantages and Limitations

- Advantages:
 - Simple and fast
 - Easy to implement
- Limitations:
 - Not cryptographically secure
 - Patterns may appear for poor parameter choices

Shahid Ashraf CS4056 16 / 41

Notes

Example 2: Problem Statement

- Use LCM with:
 - $a = 5, c = 3, m = 16, X_0 = 7$
- Generate 10 pseudo-random numbers.

Shahid Ashraf

CS4056

17 / 41

Notes

Example 2: Step-by-Step Solution

$$\begin{aligned}
 X_1 &= (5 \cdot 7 + 3) \mod 16 = 38 \mod 16 = 6 \\
 X_2 &= (5 \cdot 6 + 3) \mod 16 = 33 \mod 16 = 1 \\
 X_3 &= (5 \cdot 1 + 3) \mod 16 = 8 \mod 16 = 8 \\
 X_4 &= (5 \cdot 8 + 3) \mod 16 = 43 \mod 16 = 11 \\
 X_5 &= (5 \cdot 11 + 3) \mod 16 = 58 \mod 16 = 10 \\
 X_6 &= (5 \cdot 10 + 3) \mod 16 = 53 \mod 16 = 5 \\
 X_7 &= (5 \cdot 5 + 3) \mod 16 = 28 \mod 16 = 12 \\
 X_8 &= (5 \cdot 12 + 3) \mod 16 = 63 \mod 16 = 15 \\
 X_9 &= (5 \cdot 15 + 3) \mod 16 = 78 \mod 16 = 14 \\
 X_{10} &= (5 \cdot 14 + 3) \mod 16 = 73 \mod 16 = 9
 \end{aligned}$$

Shahid Ashraf

CS4056

18 / 41

Notes

Example 3: Problem Statement

- Use LCM with:
 - $a = 4, c = 1, m = 9, X_0 = 1$
- Generate 10 pseudo-random numbers.

Shahid Ashraf

CS4056

19 / 41

Notes

Example 3: Step-by-Step Solution

$$\begin{aligned}
 X_1 &= (4 \cdot 1 + 1) \mod 9 = 5 \\
 X_2 &= (4 \cdot 5 + 1) \mod 9 = 21 \mod 9 = 3 \\
 X_3 &= (4 \cdot 3 + 1) \mod 9 = 13 \mod 9 = 4 \\
 X_4 &= (4 \cdot 4 + 1) \mod 9 = 17 \mod 9 = 8 \\
 X_5 &= (4 \cdot 8 + 1) \mod 9 = 33 \mod 9 = 6 \\
 X_6 &= (4 \cdot 6 + 1) \mod 9 = 25 \mod 9 = 7 \\
 X_7 &= (4 \cdot 7 + 1) \mod 9 = 29 \mod 9 = 2 \\
 X_8 &= (4 \cdot 2 + 1) \mod 9 = 9 \mod 9 = 0 \\
 X_9 &= (4 \cdot 0 + 1) \mod 9 = 1 \\
 X_{10} &= (4 \cdot 1 + 1) \mod 9 = 5
 \end{aligned}$$

Shahid Ashraf

CS4056

20 / 41

Notes

Linear Congruential Method (LCM)

- Convert the integers X_i to random numbers

$$R_i = \frac{X_i}{m}, \quad i = 1, 2, \dots$$

- Note:
- $X_i \in \{0, 1, \dots, m-1\}$
- $R_i \in [0, \frac{m-1}{m}]$
- Use $X_0 = 27, a = 17, c = 43$, and $m = 100$.
- The X_i and R_i values are:

$$\begin{aligned} X_1 &= (17 \times 27 + 43) \bmod 100 = 502 \bmod 100 = 2 & \Rightarrow & R_1 = 0.02 \\ X_2 &= (17 \times 2 + 43) \bmod 100 = 77 & \Rightarrow & R_2 = 0.77 \\ X_3 &= (17 \times 77 + 43) \bmod 100 = 52 & \Rightarrow & R_3 = 0.52 \\ X_4 &= (17 \times 52 + 43) \bmod 100 = 27 & \Rightarrow & R_4 = 0.27 \end{aligned}$$

...

Shahid Ashraf

CS4056

21 / 41

Notes

Linear Congruential Method (LCM)

- Use $a = 13, c = 0$, and $m = 64$
- The period of the generator is very low
- Seed X_0 influences the sequence

i	X_i $X_0=1$	X_i $X_0=2$	X_i $X_0=3$	X_i $X_0=4$
0	1	2	3	4
1	13	26	39	52
2	41	18	59	36
3	21	42	63	20
4	17	34	51	4
5	29	58	23	
6	57	50	43	
7	37	10	47	
8	33	2	35	
9	45		7	
10	9		27	
11	53		31	
12	49		19	
13	61		55	
14	25		11	
15	5		15	
16	1		3	

Shahid Ashraf

CS4056

22 / 41

Notes

Characteristics of a good Generator

- Maximum Density
 - The values assumed by $R_i, i=1,2,\dots$ leave no large gaps on $[0,1]$
 - Problem: Instead of continuous, each R_i is discrete
 - Solution: a very large integer for modulus m
 - Approximation appears to be of little consequence
- Maximum Period
 - To achieve maximum density and avoid cycling
 - Achieved by proper choice of a, c, m , and X_0
- Most digital computers use a binary representation of numbers
 - Speed and efficiency are aided by a modulus, m , to be (or close to) a power of 2.
- The LCG has full period if and only if the following three conditions hold (Hull and Dobell, 1962):
 - The only positive integer that (exactly) divides both m and c is 1
 - If q is a prime number that divides m , then q divides $a-1$
 - If 4 divides m , then 4 divides $a-1$

Shahid Ashraf

CS4056

23 / 41

Notes

Proper choice of parameters

- For m a power 2, $m=2^b$, and $c \neq 0$
 - Longest possible period $P=m=2^b$ is achieved if c is relative prime to m and $a=1+4k$, where k is an integer
- For m a power 2, $m=2^b$, and $c=0$
 - Longest possible period $P=m/4=2^{b-2}$ is achieved if the seed X_0 is odd and $a=3+8k$ or $a=5+8k$, for $k=0,1,\dots$
- For m a prime and $c=0$
 - Longest possible period $P=m-1$ is achieved if the multiplier a has property that smallest integer k such that a^k-1 is divisible by m is $k=m-1$

Shahid Ashraf

CS4056

24 / 41

Notes

General Congruential Generators



- Linear Congruential Generators are a special case of generators defined by:

$$X_{i+1} = g(X_i, X_{i-1}, \dots) \bmod m$$

- where $g()$ is a function of previous X_i 's

- $X_i \in [0, m-1], R_i = X_i / m$

- Quadratic congruential generator
 - Defined by: $g(X_i, X_{i-1}) = aX_i^2 + bX_{i-1} + c$
- Multiple recursive generators
 - Defined by: $g(X_i, X_{i-1}, \dots) = a_1X_i + a_2X_{i-1} + \dots + a_kX_{i-k}$
- Fibonacci generator
 - Defined by: $g(X_i, X_{i-1}) = X_i + X_{i-1}$

Navigation icons: back, forward, search, etc.

Shahid Ashraf

CS4056

25 / 41

Notes

Combined Linear Congruential Generators



- Combine two or more multiplicative congruential generators.
- Aim: improve period and statistical quality.
- Typical form:

$$X_i = (X_{i,1} - X_{i,2}) \bmod (m_1 - 1)$$

- Normalized random number:

$$R_i = \begin{cases} \frac{X_i}{m_1}, & X_i > 0 \\ \frac{m_1-1}{m_1}, & X_i = 0 \end{cases}$$

Navigation icons: back, forward, search, etc.

Shahid Ashraf

CS4056

26 / 41

Notes

Question 1: Period of Combined Generators



Q: If two multiplicative generators have moduli $m_1 = 17$ and $m_2 = 19$, what is the maximum possible period of the combined generator?

Navigation icons: back, forward, search, etc.

Shahid Ashraf

CS4056

27 / 41

Notes

Question 1: Period of Combined Generators



Q: If two multiplicative generators have moduli $m_1 = 17$ and $m_2 = 19$, what is the maximum possible period of the combined generator?

A:

$$P = \frac{(m_1 - 1)(m_2 - 1)}{2} = \frac{16 \times 18}{2} = 144$$

Navigation icons: back, forward, search, etc.

Shahid Ashraf

CS4056

27 / 41

Notes

Question 2: Formulation Check

Q: Consider two generators with:

- $a_1 = 5, m_1 = 17, X_{1,0} = 3$
- $a_2 = 7, m_2 = 19, X_{2,0} = 2$

What is the first output R_1 of the combined generator?

Notes

Shahid Ashraf

CS4056

28 / 41

Question 2: Formulation Check

Q: Consider two generators with:

- $a_1 = 5, m_1 = 17, X_{1,0} = 3$
- $a_2 = 7, m_2 = 19, X_{2,0} = 2$

What is the first output R_1 of the combined generator?

A:

$$X_{1,1} = 5 \cdot 3 \mod 17 = 15$$

$$X_{2,1} = 7 \cdot 2 \mod 19 = 14$$

$$X_1 = (15 - 14) \mod 16 = 1$$

$$R_1 = \frac{1}{17} \approx 0.0588$$

Notes

Shahid Ashraf

CS4056

28 / 41

Question 3: True or False?

Statement: In a combined generator, the resulting sequence has a period equal to the least common multiple of the periods of the individual generators.

Notes

Shahid Ashraf

CS4056

29 / 41

Question 3: True or False?

Statement: In a combined generator, the resulting sequence has a period equal to the least common multiple of the periods of the individual generators.

Answer: False.

The maximum period of a properly combined generator is:

$$P = \frac{(m_1 - 1)(m_2 - 1)}{2}$$

Not the LCM.

Notes

Shahid Ashraf

CS4056

29 / 41

Question 4: Practical Use

Q: Why might we want to use combined generators instead of a single congruential generator?

A:

- To obtain longer periods (suitable for complex simulations).
- To improve statistical properties (e.g., uniformity, independence).
- To reduce correlation artifacts present in single generators.

Shahid Ashraf CS4056 30 / 41

Combined Congruential Generators

- Reason: Longer period generator is needed because of the increasing complexity of simulated systems.
- Approach: Combine two or more multiplicative congruential generators.
- Let $X_{i,1}, X_{i,2}, \dots, X_{i,k}$ be the i -th output from k different multiplicative congruential generators.
 - The j -th generator $X_{i,j}$:

$$X_{i+1,j} = (a_j X_i + c_j) \bmod m_j$$

- has prime modulus m_j , multiplier a_j , and period $m_j - 1$
- produces integers $X_{i,j}$ approx $\sim$ Uniform on $[0, m_j - 1]$
- $W_{i,j} = X_{i,j} - 1$ is approx $\sim$ Uniform on integers on $[0, m_j - 2]$

Shahid Ashraf CS4056 31 / 41

Combined Congruential Generators

- Suggested form:

$$X_i = \left(\sum_{j=1}^k (-1)^{j-1} X_{i,j} \right) \bmod m_1 - 1 \quad \text{Hence, } R_i = \begin{cases} X_i & X_i > 0 \\ \frac{m_1 - 1}{m_i} & X_i = 0 \end{cases}$$

- The maximum possible period is: $P = \frac{(m_1 - 1)(m_2 - 1) \dots (m_k - 1)}{2^{k-1}}$

Shahid Ashraf CS4056 32 / 41

Combined Congruential Generators

- Example: For 32-bit computers, combining $k = 2$ generators with $m_1 = 2147483563$, $a_1 = 40014$, $m_2 = 2147483399$ and $a_2 = 40692$.

The algorithm becomes:

Step 1: Select seeds

$X_{0,1}$ in the range $[1, 2147483562]$ for the 1st generator

$X_{0,2}$ in the range $[1, 2147483398]$ for the 2nd generator

Step 2: For each individual generator,

$X_{i+1,1} = 40014 \times X_{i,1} \bmod 2147483563$

$X_{i+1,2} = 40692 \times X_{i,2} \bmod 2147483399$

Step 3: $X_{i+1} = (X_{i+1,1} - X_{i+1,2}) \bmod 2147483562$

Step 4: Return

$$R_{i+1} = \begin{cases} \frac{X_{i+1}}{2147483563}, & X_{i+1} > 0 \\ \frac{2147483562}{2147483563}, & X_{i+1} = 0 \end{cases}$$

Step 5: Set $i = i + 1$, go back to step 2.

- Combined generator has period: $(m_1 - 1)(m_2 - 1)/2 \sim 2 \times 10^{18}$

Shahid Ashraf CS4056 33 / 41

Notes

Notes

Notes

Notes

Combined Congruential Generators

- In Excel 2003 and 2007 new Random Number Generator

$$X, Y, Z \in \{1, \dots, 30000\}$$

$$X = X \cdot 171 \bmod 30269$$

$$Y = Y \cdot 172 \bmod 30307$$

$$Z = Z \cdot 170 \bmod 30323$$

$$R = \left(\frac{X}{30269} + \frac{Y}{30307} + \frac{Z}{30323} \right) \bmod 1.0$$

- It is stated that this method produces more than 10^{13} numbers

Notes

Random-Numbers Streams

- The seed for a linear congruential random-number generator:
 - Is the integer value X_0 that initializes the random-number sequence
 - Any value in the sequence $(X_0, X_1, \dots, X_p)$ can be used to "seed" the generator

- A random-number stream:

- Refers to a starting seed taken from the sequence $(X_0, X_1, \dots, X_p)$

- If the streams are b values apart, then stream i is defined by starting seed:

$$S_i = X_{b(i-1)} \quad i = 1, 2, \dots, \left\lfloor \frac{p}{b} \right\rfloor$$

- Older generators: $b = 10^5$

- Newer generators: $b = 10^{17}$

- A single random-number generator with k streams can act like k distinct virtual random-number generators
- To compare two or more alternative systems.
 - Advantageous to dedicate portions of the pseudo-random number sequence to the same purpose in each of the simulated systems.

Notes

Tests for Random Numbers

- The seed for a linear congruential random-number generator:
 - Is the integer value X_0 that initializes the random-number sequence
 - Any value in the sequence $(X_0, X_1, \dots, X_p)$ can be used to "seed" the generator

- A random-number stream:

- Refers to a starting seed taken from the sequence $(X_0, X_1, \dots, X_p)$

- If the streams are b values apart, then stream i is defined by starting seed:

$$S_i = X_{b(i-1)} \quad i = 1, 2, \dots, \left\lfloor \frac{p}{b} \right\rfloor$$

- Older generators: $b = 10^5$

- Newer generators: $b = 10^{17}$

- A single random-number generator with k streams can act like k distinct virtual random-number generators
- To compare two or more alternative systems.
 - Advantageous to dedicate portions of the pseudo-random number sequence to the same purpose in each of the simulated systems.

Notes

Tests for Random Numbers

- Two categories:

- Testing for **uniformity**:

$$H_0: R_i \sim U[0,1]$$

$$H_1: R_i \sim U[0,1]$$

- Failure to reject the null hypothesis, H_0 , means that evidence of non-uniformity has not been detected.

- Testing for **independence**:

$$H_0: R_i \sim \text{independent}$$

$$H_1: R_i \sim \text{independent}$$

- Failure to reject the null hypothesis, H_0 , means that evidence of dependence has not been detected.

- Level of significance α , the probability of rejecting H_0 when it is true:

$$\alpha = P(\text{reject } H_0 \mid H_0 \text{ is true})$$

Notes

Tests for Random Numbers



- When to use these tests:
 - If a well-known simulation language or random-number generator is used, it is probably unnecessary to test
 - If the generator is not explicitly known or documented, e.g., spreadsheet programs, symbolic/numerical calculators, tests should be applied to many sample numbers.
- Types of tests:
 - Theoretical tests: evaluate the choices of m , a , and c without actually generating any numbers
 - Empirical tests: applied to actual sequences of numbers produced.
 - Our emphasis.

Shahid Ashraf

CS4056

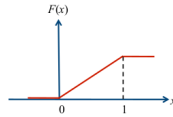
38 / 41

Frequency tests: Kolmogorov-Smirnov Test



- Compares the continuous CDF, $F(x)$, of the uniform distribution with the empirical CDF, $S_N(x)$, of the N sample observations.

- We know: $F(x) = x, 0 \leq x \leq 1$



- If the sample from the RNG is $R_1, R_2, \dots, R_N$, then the empirical CDF, $S_N(x)$ is:

$$S_N(x) = \frac{\text{Number of } R_i \text{ where } R_i \leq x}{N}$$

- Based on the statistic: $D = \max |F(x) - S_N(x)|$
- Sampling distribution of D is known

Shahid Ashraf

CS4056

39 / 41

Frequency tests: Kolmogorov-Smirnov Test



- The test consists of the following steps
- Step 1:** Rank the data from smallest to largest
 $R_{(1)} \leq R_{(2)} \leq \dots \leq R_{(N)}$

- Step 2:** Compute

$$D^+ = \max_{1 \leq i \leq N} \left\{ \frac{i}{N} - R_{(i)} \right\}$$

$$D^- = \max_{1 \leq i \leq N} \left\{ R_{(i)} - \frac{i-1}{N} \right\}$$

- Step 3:** Compute $D = \max(D^+, D^-)$

- Step 4:** Get D_α for the significance level α

- Step 5:** If $D \leq D_\alpha$ accept, otherwise reject H_0

Kolmogorov-Smirnov Critical Values

Degrees of Freedom (N)	$D_{0.10}$	$D_{0.05}$	$D_{0.01}$
1	0.950	0.975	0.995
2	0.776	0.842	0.929
3	0.642	0.708	0.828
4	0.564	0.624	0.733
5	0.510	0.553	0.669
6	0.470	0.521	0.618
7	0.438	0.486	0.577
8	0.411	0.457	0.543
9	0.388	0.432	0.514
10	0.368	0.410	0.490
11	0.352	0.391	0.468
12	0.338	0.375	0.450
13	0.325	0.361	0.433
14	0.314	0.349	0.418
15	0.304	0.338	0.404
16	0.295	0.328	0.392
17	0.286	0.318	0.381
18	0.278	0.309	0.371
19	0.272	0.301	0.363
20	0.264	0.294	0.356
25	0.24	0.27	0.32
30	0.22	0.24	0.29
35	0.21	0.23	0.27
Over 35	1.22 $\sqrt{N}$	1.36 $\sqrt{N}$	1.63 $\sqrt{N}$

Shahid Ashraf

CS4056

40 / 41

Frequency tests: Kolmogorov-Smirnov Test



- Example: Suppose $N=5$ numbers: 0.44, 0.81, 0.14, 0.05, 0.93.

i	1	2	3	4	5
$R_{(i)}$	0.05	0.14	0.44	0.81	0.93
i/N	0.20	0.40	0.60	0.80	1.00
$i/N - R_{(i)}$	0.15	0.26	0.16	-	0.07
$R_{(i)} - (i-1)/N$	0.05	-	0.04	0.21	0.13

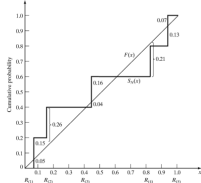
Arrange $R_{(i)}$ from smallest to largest

$$D^+ = \max \{i/N - R_{(i)}\}$$

$$D^- = \max \{R_{(i)} - (i-1)/N\}$$

Step 3: $D = \max(D^+, D^-) = 0.26$ Step 4: For $\alpha = 0.05$,

$$D_\alpha = 0.565 > D = 0.26$$

Hence, H_0 is not rejected.

Shahid Ashraf

CS4056

41 / 41

Notes

Notes

Notes

Notes
